TIMELEX

Legal practice management with an autonomy ladder

YEAR	ROLE	TEAM	STATUS
2026	Product design, architecture, systems engineering	Solo build	Public source · pre-alpha

Summary

An open, API-first legal practice platform designed to capture work signals, attribute them to the right matter and prepare the bill, asking a person only when it must.

The problem

Lawyers lose billable time in the gap between the work and the record of it. A platform that watches everything creates a different problem: it puts sensitive client material into a system that may not deserve that trust.

TimeLex is designed around earned autonomy. It captures work signals, attributes them to the right matter with cited evidence, writes the narrative and prepares the bill, and asks a person only when the decision is consequential.

What is built

- An autonomy ladder from Observe to Autonomous-to-pre-bill (L0 to L4) where trust is earned per decision type from sampled precision and demotion is automatic. Some actions, such as moving trust money or sending a fee note, are never autonomous.
- An MCP-host agent runtime and a bring-your-own-keys vault specified in ADRs: each firm carries its own model cost, and captured emails and documents are treated as data, never as instructions.
- Twelve ADRs, eight research notes, a threat model and contract-first OpenAPI, event and MCP schemas, with accuracy gates planned before any autonomy is built.
- A working skeleton: the gateway and identity services in Rust, shared auth, database and billing-unit crates, a Python redaction worker and a TypeScript SDK stub, with five GitHub Actions workflows including CodeQL, dependency review and a supply-chain scorecard.

Decisions that matter

Earned autonomy

Choice. The autonomy ladder stops before trust money and fee notes.

Why. Consequential decisions keep a person in the loop.

Trade-off. Some work stays manual until the evidence earns more autonomy.

Bring your own keys

Choice. Each firm supplies and pays for its own model access.

Why. Cost and control stay with the firm.

Trade-off. Setup is a real onboarding task.

Capture signals, not surveillance

Choice. The system records work signals instead of hoarding client material.

Why. The platform does not deserve trust it has not earned.

Trade-off. Coverage is narrower than passive capture.

Stack

`Rust` `Python` `TypeScript` `PostgreSQL` `MCP` `Claude`

Where to look

- Source on GitHub: https://github.com/konethegreat/timelex
- Case study: konethegreat.github.io/work/timelex